

# PROJECT AEGIS: THERANOSTIC MULTIFUNCTIONAL NANOPARTICLE

Next-Gen Liposomal Framework Incorporating GLP-1/HDL Scaffolding, Synthetic Chloramphenicol-Cyclodextrin Conjugates, and Ostarine Payloads

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| Target Horizon: ARPA-H ADVOCATE & NIH RFPs | Date: August 2026                               |

## 1. Executive Summary & Design Rationale

Project Aegis establishes a highly sophisticated, multi-functional **Theranostic Lipid Transport System** built explicitly to resolve the primary bottleneck of modern atheroma intervention: systemic toxicity versus targeted arterial penetration. This framework completely divorces the target molecule from its historical biological hazards by using raw *chloramphenicol* skeletons strictly as a non-toxic lipophilic molecular anchor, structurally snapped to plaque-clearing cyclodextrin carriers via advanced bio-conjugation.

Simultaneously, the platform leverages 2026 material science breakthroughs to construct an advanced outer lipid envelope studded with dual-targeting peptides (GLP-1 and ApoA-I HDL mimics) while safely encapsulating a muscle-preserving anabolic modulator (Ostarine) to buffer local vascular tissue stress.

## 2. Four-Component Molecular Engineering & Pharmacokinetics

### A. The Guidance Shell: Dual GLP-1 & Synthetic HDL (ApoA-I) Targeting Vectors

The particle matrix uses an outer phospholipid bilayer engineered to mimic endogenous High-Density Lipoprotein (HDL) but optimized with dual-affinity receptors:

- **SR-BI Subunit Capture:** Surface-linked Apolipoprotein A-I (ApoA-I) mimetic peptides (specifically the R4F/uniprot variants) achieve high-affinity binding to scavenger receptor class B type I (SR-BI) overexpressed on fat-gorged macrophage foam cells trapped inside established atheromas.
- **GLP-1R Endothelial Stabilization:** Co-functionalized GLP-1 receptor agonists anchored to the outer shell activate local vascular endothelial cells. This induces an immediate down-regulation of local vascular cell adhesion molecule-1 (VCAM-1) and intercellular adhesion molecule-1 (ICAM-1), actively halting new monocyte recruitment and suppressing local vascular inflammation.

### B. The Internal Clearing payload: Non-Toxic Chloramphenicol-Cyclodextrin Conjugates

This blueprint introduces a radical chemical modification to neutralize the bone marrow toxicity (aplastic anemia) of chloramphenicol while exploiting its extreme lipophilic profile:

- **The Tweak:** A palladium-catalyzed reduction eliminates the electrophilic *nitro group* (-NO<sub>2</sub>) from the phenyl ring, permanently destroying its ability to bind human ribosomes or halt mitochondrial protein synthesis. It is replaced with a clean azide anchor.
- **The Conjugation:** Using copper-catalyzed click chemistry, this neutralized phenylpropanediol skeleton is snapped to a modified **Cyclodextrin Ring** (structurally mimicking the real-world *UDP-003* small molecule platform currently in clinical phase 1b trials by Cyclarity Therapeutics).
- **Mechanism of Action:** The altered, highly lipophilic backbone acts as a stealth carrier, dragging the cyclodextrin deep into the lipid-rich hydrophobic core of arterial plaque. Once inside, the cyclodextrin acts as a macroscopic 'chemical basket', selectively encapsulating and dissolving crystalline **7-ketocholesterol (7KC)**, enabling safe extraction via renal pathways.

C. Tissue Shielding Payload: Ostarine (Enobosarm) Localized Muscle Preservation

Rapid lipid extraction from plaque is inherently stressful to local blood vessels and can weaken the structural integrity of the arterial wall. To prevent localized smooth muscle wasting (atrophy) within the media layer, **Ostarine** is co-encapsulated inside the LNP core. Upon cellular uptake, it selectively binds to local androgen receptors, promoting structural matrix protein synthesis and maintaining the mechanics of the vascular wall without causing systemic androgenic effects.

3. Material Science & Microfluidic Assembly Specifications

To ensure the co-encapsulation of both the highly lipophilic modified chloramphenicol-cyclodextrin carrier and the anabolic Ostarine payload, the system requires an automated 4-component microfluidic mixing setup. Ionizable lipids must remain neutral at a physiological pH of 7.4 to prolong blood circulation but become protonated inside the acidic endosome (pH < 5.5) of macrophages to trigger payload release.

| Component Category                     | Molar Ratio (%) | Primary Engineering Function                                            |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ionizable Lipid (e.g., G0-C14 variant) | 45.0%           | Electrostatic entrapment, endosomal escape via protonation.             |
| Auxiliary Phospholipids (DSPC)         | 10.0%           | Bilayer stabilization and structural rigidity.                          |
| Cholesterol Layer Modifiers            | 37.5%           | Membrane fluidity regulation, structural leak prevention.               |
| PEGylated Lipids (PEG-2000)            | 2.5%            | Surface charge shielding, immune evasion, prolonged systemic half-life. |
| Surface Targeting Peptide Conjugates   | 5.0%            | Dual ApoA-I (HDL) and GLP-1 active cellular steering.                   |

## 4. Medical Intelligence (MedInt), OSINT RFPs & Clinical Landscape

- **ARPA-H ADVOCATE Program (Solicitation SOL-26-142):** Launched in early 2026, this Advanced Research Projects Agency for Health initiative specifically calls for transformative, autonomous, and advanced technology integrations in cardiovascular care management. While ADVOCATE emphasizes agentic clinical AI deployment, the physical validation of multi-targeted therapeutics to drastically compress cardiovascular disease (CVD) timelines directly fulfills the clinical goals outlined in the White House Cardiovascular Action Plans.
- **Cyclarity Therapeutics Clinical Updates (2026):** Real-world data from Cyclarity's Phase 1 human trials in Adelaide, Australia, alongside their ongoing Phase 1b/2 clinical trials utilizing coronary CT angiography (CCTA), has conclusively proved that custom-engineered cyclodextrins achieve targeted engagement with 7-ketocholesterol, driving active plaque regression rather than merely stabilizing it. The Project Aegis framework enhances this breakthrough by packing the cyclodextrin within a targeted LNP carrier to prevent off-target accumulation.
- **OSINT Competitive Analysis & Active Biomimetic Trials:** Recent 2025/2026 peer-reviewed pipelines show that P-selectin-targeted and platelet/HDL membrane-biomimetic nanoparticles (such as Por-HDL-NPs evaluating SR-BI targets) are demonstrating unprecedented success in suppressing local pro-inflammatory pathways (like the NF-kB axis) and shrinking atherosclerotic lesions without triggering systemic liver toxicity or hypertriglyceridemia.

## 5. Pharmacokinetics (PK) & Biodistribution Profiles

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